

The production process	Innovation, research and development	• explain what is meant by innovation, research and development • explain the reasons for innovation, research and development within a business and an industry • explain what is meant by product innovation and process innovation • explain the process/cycle of innovation, research and development • evaluate the advantages and disadvantages of innovation, research and development to a business • evaluate the importance of innovation, research and development to a business, to the consumer, other stakeholders and the economy.
	Methods of production	• distinguish between methods of production: job, batch, flow and cell • evaluate the impact and importance of the choice of production method to a business and its stakeholders • evaluate the reasons for the choice of production method • explain what is meant by specialisation and the division of labour • explain the reasons for the introduction of specialisation and division of labour into a business • evaluate the impact and importance of specialisation and division of labour to a business and its stakeholders.

Area of Study	Content	Learners should be able to:
The production process	Services	• explain the production process for the provision of services • explain what is meant by customer service in the context of the provision of services • evaluate the importance of high quality customer service to a business and its stakeholders.
	Project management	• explain what is meant by project management • explain the reasons for using project management within a business • explain how and why quantitative methods of project management are used by a business: including Gantt charts, critical path analysis (CPA), program evaluation and review technique (PERT) • explain the nature and purpose of Gantt charts and network analysis diagrams • complete and interpret Gantt charts: including duration and overlap • calculate and interpret earliest start times (EST), latest finish times (LFT), total float and free float and identify the critical path using CPA • calculate and interpret optimistic time (O), pessimistic time (P), most likely time (M), expected time, total float and free float and identify the critical path using PERT • evaluate the usefulness of quantitative methods of project management to a business and its stakeholders • evaluate the impact and importance of quantitative methods of project management to a business and its stakeholders • explain the qualitative factors which might affect project management in a business • evaluate the impact and importance of qualitative factors affecting project management to a business and its stakeholders.